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*United Nations Relief and Works Agency for Palestine
Refugees in the near east*

*Paperwork and Procedural Guide
SMUN, 2026*

*Agenda: Safeguarding Humanitarian Corridors in Active Conflict Zones While Upholding
Neutrality and International Humanitarian Law aimed to address all forms of Violence with a
Special Emphasis on the Palestinian refugees in the Near East*

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Note from the Executive Board

The Executive Board welcomes all delegates to committee. The procedural guide enclosed has been prepared for you to read carefully before committee begins as it outlines the Rules of Procedure, working paper and draft resolution formats, as well as all guidelines regarding debate. A clear understanding of these rules is essential in ensuring smooth, efficient, and productive sessions. Delegates are encouraged to read through the document, and may approach the dais at any time for procedural clarifications.

It is also to note, **that the deadline for the submission of the position paper is 18th April 2026, 11:59 PM.**

The submission of the position paper is mandatory for being considered for the award allocation process.

All position papers are to be mailed at: unrwa2026.smun@gmail.com

Regards,
The Executive Board
(UNRWA)



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Rules of Procedure

All committees at Model United Nations conferences are governed and dictated by a well-defined set of regulations. This section aims to introduce the aforementioned, and delegates are requested to read it thoroughly.

The committee proceedings begin with a roll call. During the roll call, the Executive Board calls out the names of all countries in alphabetical order, and the delegates may respond in the following ways:

(i) Present - When delegates respond with 'present', they are given the option to abstain, i.e., neither vote in favour nor vote against a document in substantive voting. Substantive voting relates to voting for draft resolutions, amendments, inter alia.

(ii) Present and voting - When delegates respond with 'present and voting', they are required to either vote for or against a document in substantive voting. They are not given the option of abstention.

It is important to note that all delegates are required to vote for procedural matters such as passing a motion for a moderated caucus, passing a motion for an unmoderated caucus, inter alia. No abstention is permitted in procedural votes.

Forms of Debate:

The forms of debate are broadly classified into two categories:

Formal Debate :

Discussion in formal debate can be done through the General Speakers' List and the Provisional Speakers' List.

(i) General Speakers' List (GSL) - In a GSL, each delegate, by default, gets 90 seconds to speak. However, delegates may choose to amend this time if they feel it necessary. If a delegate finishes their speech before the allotted time, they are required to yield it, as explained later. There is no topic for a GSL, and delegates may use it to discuss whatever they feel is relevant. They can use it to give an introduction to the agenda, present their stance, highlight problems, inter alia. The GSL is an inexhaustible list and remains open throughout the conference.

(ii) Provisional Speakers' List (PSL) - A PSL differs from a GSL as it is conducted on a specific topic and can be exhausted. The total time of the list, along with the individual speaker's time, must be specified. In case delegates finish their speeches before it has elapsed, they are required to yield the remaining time.

Informal Debate

Discussion in the informal debate can be done via moderated and unmoderated caucuses.

(i) Moderated Caucus - Moderated caucuses are of the utmost importance in a committee as they enable delegates to streamline debate. This allows delegates to debate a specific subtopic of the agenda within the prescribed time.

(ii) Unmoderated Caucus - Unmoderated caucuses are a form of informal debate where the delegates are allowed to speak directly to each other. Unmoderated caucuses are used to discuss potential moderated caucus topics, to complete documentation, as well as for lobbying and building blocs.

Motions:

A motion is raised when a delegate wants to lead the committee in a specific direction.

The following are the types of motions that will be used in the committee:

Motion to Open Debate

This motion is raised to commence debate in the committee. It is raised at the beginning of the first committee session on the first day of the conference. How to raise the motion: "The Delegate of the State of Israel would like to raise a motion to open debate."

Motion to Open the General Speakers' List

This motion is raised when a delegate would like to open the General Speakers List and hence commence formal debate. The total time need not be specified, as the GSL is inexhaustible and is reverted to in case all motions fail to pass in committee. How to raise the motion:

“The Delegate of the Syrian Arab Republic would like to raise a motion to enter formal debate and open the General Speakers’ List”

Motion for a Moderated Caucus

This motion is used when the committee wants to discuss specific subtopics of the agenda. While raising this motion, the topic, total time, and the individual speaker’s time must be mentioned. It is important to note that the total time of a moderated caucus must be divisible by the speaker’s time to incorporate a whole number of speakers before the moderated caucus elapses. The maximum total time it can be raised for is 20 minutes.

How to raise the motion: “The Delegate of the Syrian Arab Republic would like to raise a motion for a moderated caucus on the topic ‘XYZ’ for a total time being 15 minutes and the individual speaker’s time being 60 seconds”

Motion for an Unmoderated Caucus

During the first few committee sessions, unmoderated caucuses are used to build blocs, converse with other delegates, and discuss potential moderated caucus topics, while in the last few committee sessions, they are primarily used for completing documentation. Just like moderated caucuses, the maximum time an unmoderated caucus can be raised is 20 minutes. However, unmoderated caucuses do not have a topic or an individual speaker’s time.

How to raise the motion: “The delegate of the State of Kuwait would like to raise a motion for an unmoderated caucus for a total time of 10 minutes”

Motion for Extension

This motion is used to extend a moderated or unmoderated caucus. It must be kept in mind that they can only be extended by half of the original time they were raised.

If an unmoderated caucus was originally raised for 10 minutes, then for an extension, the motion would be raised by stating: “The delegate of the Syrian Arab Republic would like to raise a motion to extend the unmoderated caucus by a total time of 5 Minutes”

Motion to open a Provisional Speakers’ List

The motion to open a PSL is generally used for debate when the committee is in crisis or to discuss documentation. Whilst raising this motion, delegates need to specify the topic, the total time, and the individual speaker's time. How to raise the motion: "The delegate of the State of Israel would like to raise a motion to open a Provisional Speakers' List on the topic 'ABC' for a total time being 10 minutes and an individual speaker's time being 60 seconds"

Motion to Introduce a Working Paper/Draft Resolution

This motion is raised to introduce documentation to the committee, which is a prerequisite for the document to be discussed. The name of the draft resolution or the working paper is to be specified while introducing the document to the committee.

How to raise the motion: "The delegate of the Syrian Arab Republic would like to raise a motion to introduce Draft Resolution 1.0 to the committee"

Motion to Discuss a Working Paper/Draft Resolution

This motion is used to discuss a Working Paper or Draft Resolution. Delegates may point out loopholes, suggest modifications, and bring up features they feel are relevant while discussing a document to make it more comprehensive, effective, and implementable. The authors of a working paper and the sponsors for a draft resolution are answerable to the committee regarding the content of their documentation. When raising this motion, the delegates are required to mention how they want the documentation to be discussed.

Motion to Move into Amendment Procedure for a Draft Resolution

After the discussion of a draft resolution, delegates may choose to move into the amendment procedure to suggest an addition, modification, or deletion of clauses. They can suggest changes by sending amendment chits to the Executive Board. When the amendments are introduced, the sponsors of the draft resolution may deem them friendly or unfriendly by consensus.

(i) A **friendly amendment** does not need to be voted upon and is directly incorporated into the resolution

(ii) An **unfriendly amendment** has to be voted upon and needs to obtain the votes a special majority of at least 2/3rds of the strength of the committee to be incorporated into the draft resolution.

Delegates are to note that there is no amendment procedure for working papers.

How to raise the motion: “The delegate of Belize would like to raise a motion to move into the amendment procedure for Draft Resolution 2.0”

Motion to Close Debate, Move into Voting Procedure for a Draft Resolution

This motion is raised to move into the voting procedure for a draft resolution. A draft resolution requires a special majority comprising 2/3rds of the committee's strength in order to pass. Once a draft resolution passes, it is adopted and is considered the final document of the committee, representing the conclusion it has come to. It is important to note that once a draft resolution passes, voting will not be conducted for any other resolutions. The voting for a resolution is done through a roll call vote. In a roll call vote, the Executive Board calls out the names of the countries present in the committee in alphabetical order, and the delegates may respond with yes, no, abstain, yes with rights, or no with rights.

- (i) Delegates may respond with a **yes** to vote in favour of the draft resolution,
- (ii) Delegates may respond with a **no** to vote against the draft resolution,
- (iii) Delegates may respond with an **abstention** (abstain) if they wish to neither vote in favour of nor vote against the resolution.

However, delegates can only **abstain** if they responded with **‘Present’ during their roll call**.

- (iv). Delegates may respond with **yes/no with rights** when they vote in favour of or against a resolution and wish to give reasons for the same.

They are then given a 30-second comment after voting for all delegates is complete.

No voting procedure will be conducted for passing the working papers.

How to raise the motion: “The delegate of the Republic of Cuba would like to raise a motion to move into the voting procedure for Draft Resolution 1.0 through a roll call vote”

Motion to Recess

This motion is used to temporarily suspend debate at the end of each committee session.

How to raise the motion: “The delegate of the Kingdom of Spain would like to raise the motion for the committee to recess” Motion to Adjourn. This motion is raised on the last day of the conference to conclude committee proceedings. How to raise the motion: “The delegate of the People’s Republic of China would like to raise the motion to adjourn the committee”

Ways to discuss documentation

Documentation is primarily discussed via the following methods:

1. A **clause-by-clause discussion** is when every clause of the document is discussed thoroughly. Delegates can question the authors or sponsors of the document after every clause.
2. A **moderated caucus discussion** enables the delegates to raise concerns and question the authors or sponsors of the document in their speeches. There is no direct question and answer session in this form of discussion.
3. A **provisional speakers' list** allows delegates to talk about the document in their speeches, and if they have time left, they may yield it.

How to raise the motion: "The delegate of the United States of America would like to raise a motion to discuss Draft Resolution 1.0 through a moderated caucus with a total time of 15 minutes and individual speakers' time of 1 minute"

Yields:

Yields are used when a delegate has time remaining after their speech in formal methods of debate. Delegates may yield their remaining time in the following ways:

Yield to the Chair

When a delegate yields to the Chair, their remaining time is dissolved with the committee time.

Yield to Points of Information (POIs) When a delegate yields to points of information, other delegates may ask them questions based on their speech. The number of POIs recognised by the chair will depend on the time remaining from the speech.

Yield to Another Delegate

When a delegate yields their time to another delegate, the delegate to whom the remaining time is yielded may comment on the original speech given or further build upon it. Delegates are to

confer with each other and obtain prior permission before yielding their time to another delegate.

Yield to Comments

When a delegate yields to comments, speakers are recognised to make comments regarding the speech for the remaining time.

Delegates are to note that they are not required to yield their time in informal methods of Debate.

Points:

Through points, delegates can ask a question in the committee, clarify their queries, point out procedural errors, inter alia. Points can be categorised as follows:

Point of Personal Privilege

This point is used when a delegate experiences personal discomfort or inconvenience that hinders their ability to participate in the committee. For example, this point can be used if the delegate wants the Executive board or a fellow delegate to repeat anything. This is the only point that delegates can raise whilst another delegate has the floor in committee.

Point of Parliamentary Inquiry

This point is used when a delegate needs clarification or has a question about committee procedure. For example, this point can be used if a delegate requires clarification regarding yields.

Point of Information

This point is used when a delegate wishes to ask another delegate a question after they complete their speech or at any point in committee. However, verbal Points of Information will only be entertained during the formal debate if the delegate yields to POIs. If a delegate wishes to ask a POI after a moderated caucus speech, they may do so through a chit via the Executive Board.

Point of Order

This point is used when an error has been committed in the rules of procedure by the Executive Board.

Right to Reply

A right to reply is used by a delegate to comment or reply when they feel their integrity has been compromised due to personal allegations, insults, or comments made about them. If a Right to Reply is granted, then the delegate will be allowed to speak immediately, outside the list of speakers.

Paperwork:

Chits:

In Model United Nations (MUN), chits are written notes used by delegates to communicate during committee sessions. They are commonly used to ask questions without interrupting formal debate.

Chits sent via the Executive Board (EB) are sent through the EB and are marked. They are usually for formal purposes, such as questions to speakers or communication with the chair.

Chits sent not via the EB are informal notes exchanged directly between delegates, typically for lobbying, negotiations, or bloc formation.

Presidential Statements:

In the Model United Nations (MUN), Presidential Statements are released after a crisis and are generally used to signify a change in a country's foreign policy.

Working Paper Guidelines

Working papers are often the precursors to draft resolutions in that the delegates can outline the issues of a topic area or propose solutions without a particular format. A working paper may not be voted upon and may only contain signatories. Some chairs, however, may request that working papers be submitted in resolution format. For this

committee, working papers will have both authors and signatories. Also, using a resolution format may prove useful when converting the document to a resolution.

Working papers should ideally be detailed by the usage of the following format:

Main Clause;

Main Clause:

(Sub-clause),

(Sub-clause),

(Sub-clause):

(Sub-sub-clause),

(Sub-sub-clause),

(Sub-sub-clause);

More information, regarding the maximum number of authors for working papers and other specifics, will be given to the delegates in the committee.

Draft Resolution Guidelines

The three days of debate are ultimately directed towards reaching a consensus and forming a resolution, known as the Draft Resolution (DR), that delineates how the Member States must tackle the various issues of the agenda. A good Draft Resolution requires a well-rounded approach to the agenda and must be supported with a realistic framework for implementation.

Delegates must ensure that all solutions proposed during committee or presented in the Draft Resolution fall within the purview of the mandate of the United Nations Relief and Works Agency.

Preamble of a Draft Resolution

The **Preamble of a Draft Resolution** states the purpose of addressing the agenda at hand and highlights past international action on the issue. Each clause begins with a

present participle, called a perambulatory phrase which is italicised, and the clause always ends with a comma. These clauses can include references to the UN charter, citations of past UN resolutions or treaties on the agenda, acknowledgement of statements made by the Secretary-General or a UN body or agency, recognition of the efforts of regional or non-governmental organisations, and general statements on the topic and its importance.

Some sample preambulatory phrases are:

Affirming	Deeply regretting	Having examined	Seeking
Alarmed by	Viewing with appreciation	Having received	Taking into consideration
Approving	Desiring	Keeping in mind	Taking into account
Bearing in mind	Emphasising	Noting with deep concern	Believing
Regretting	Noting with satisfaction	Confident	Expressing its appreciation
Further noting	Contemplating	Acknowledging	Fulfilling
Fully aware of	Further realising	Deeply concerned	Expressing
Having deliberated	Deeply conscious	Referring	Recognising
Deeply disturbed	Guided by	Deeply Convinced	Realising

Operative clauses of a Draft Resolution

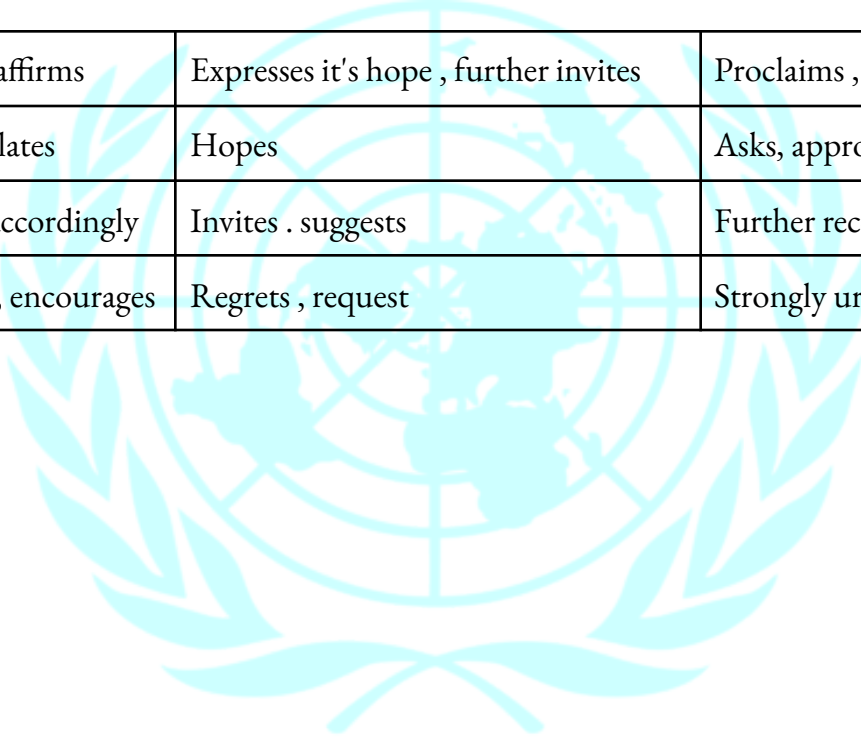
Operative clauses are meant to offer solutions to issues addressed during the procession of the committee. These clauses are *action-oriented and should include both an underlined verb at the beginning of the sentence followed by the proposed solution*. Each clause should follow the following Principles.

1. Clauses must be numbered;
2. Each clause should support another and continue to build your solution;

3. Add details to your clauses in order to have a complete solution;
4. Operative clauses must be punctuated by a semicolon, with the exception of the last operative clause, which should end with a period.

Some sample operative phrases are:

Accepts , affirms	Expresses it's hope , further invites	Proclaims , resolves
Congratulates	Hopes	Asks, approves
Declares accordingly	Invites . suggests	Further recommends
Endorses , encourages	Regrets , request	Strongly urges



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